THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Media Relations Policy

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Review cycle	Every Three Years

Executive Summary

The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) recognizes the media as an important partner in informing the public, promoting accountability and increasing awareness of sustainable development initiatives.

This Policy establishes principles and procedures for engaging with the media in a professional, transparent and consistent manner while protecting the Foundation's reputation, beneficiaries and confidential information.

1. Purpose

This Policy aims to:

- Promote accurate and timely public communication.
- Strengthen positive relationships with media organizations.
- Protect the Foundation's reputation.
- Ensure consistent organizational messaging.
- Support transparency and accountability.
- Safeguard confidential and sensitive information.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- Board of Trustees.
- Executive leadership.
- Employees.
- Volunteers.
- Consultants.
- Contractors.
- Individuals authorized to speak on behalf of TJF.

It covers interactions with:

- Newspapers.
- Television.

- Radio.
- Online news platforms.
- Podcasts.
- Bloggers.
- Documentary producers.
- Freelance journalists.
- Other media representatives.

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3. Guiding Principles

Media engagement should be:

- Accurate.
- Honest.
- Timely.
- Respectful.
- Professional.
- Evidence-based.
- Consistent with TJF's mission and values.

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4. Official Spokespersons

The following may act as official spokespersons unless authority is delegated:

- Executive Director.
- Chairperson of the Board (for governance matters, where appropriate).
- Communications & Public Relations Manager.
- Other staff expressly authorized by the Executive Director.

Staff should not present personal opinions as official TJF positions.

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5. Media Enquiries

All media enquiries should be directed to the Communications & Public Relations Department.

The Department should:

- Log the request.
- Confirm the scope of the enquiry.
- Coordinate internal input where necessary.
- Prepare approved responses.
- Arrange interviews when appropriate.

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6. Interviews

Before interviews:

- Confirm the purpose and topic.
- Identify the intended audience.
- Agree on logistics.
- Prepare key messages.
- Review any sensitive issues.

During interviews:

- Be factual and concise.
- Avoid speculation.
- Respect confidentiality.
- Correct inaccuracies politely.
- State when information is unavailable rather than guessing.

After interviews:

- Document key discussion points.
- Monitor published coverage.
- Correct significant factual errors where appropriate.

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7. Press Releases

Press releases may be issued for:

- Programme launches.
- Major achievements.
- Partnerships.
- Funding announcements.
- Research findings.
- Public events.
- Awards and recognition.
- Official organizational statements.

All press releases should be reviewed and approved before publication.

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8. Press Conferences

Press conferences may be organized when:

- Announcing major initiatives.
- Responding to significant public interest.
- Addressing emergencies or crises.
- Releasing important reports.

The Communications Department should coordinate invitations, briefing materials and logistics.

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9. Protection of Beneficiaries

Media engagement must respect the dignity, privacy and safety of beneficiaries.

TJF should:

- Obtain informed consent before publishing identifiable information or images where required.
- Avoid sensationalism.
- Protect children and other vulnerable individuals.
- Refrain from sharing confidential personal information.

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10. Confidential Information

The following should not be disclosed without authorization:

- Personal information.
- Confidential donor information.
- Financial information not approved for release.
- Legal matters under review.
- Personnel records.
- Sensitive security information.

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11. Handling Inaccurate Media Coverage

Where inaccurate information is published, the Communications Department should:

1. Verify the facts.
2. Assess the significance of the error.
3. Contact the relevant media outlet.
4. Request a correction or clarification where appropriate.
5. Document the outcome.

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12. Crisis Media Relations

During a crisis:

- Communications should be centralized.
- Only authorized spokespersons may issue public statements.
- Information should be verified before release.
- Updates should be provided as appropriate.

Refer to the **Crisis Communication Plan** for detailed procedures.

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13. Media Monitoring

The Communications Department should monitor:

- News coverage.
- Broadcast media.
- Online publications.
- Social media discussions relevant to TJF.

Monitoring results should inform communication planning and reputation management.

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14. Record Keeping

Maintain records of:

- Media enquiries.
- Interviews.
- Press releases.
- Press conference materials.
- Published coverage.
- Media contact lists.

Records should be retained in accordance with TJF's Records Management Policy.

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15. Roles and Responsibilities

Board of Trustees

- Oversees matters affecting organizational reputation.

Executive Director

- Approves major public statements.
- Serves as lead spokesperson or delegates authority.

Communications & Public Relations Department

Responsible for:

- Media engagement.
- Press releases.
- Media monitoring.
- Spokesperson support.
- Media training.
- Reputation management.

All Staff

Staff should:

- Refer media enquiries appropriately.
- Avoid unauthorized public statements.
- Protect confidential information.
- Support approved communication activities.

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16. Review

This Policy should be reviewed:

- Every three years.
- Following significant media incidents.
- After major organizational changes.
- When communication practices or legal requirements change.

Conclusion

Constructive engagement with the media helps strengthen public understanding, accountability and confidence in The Jopetnah Foundation.

By following this Policy, TJF ensures that media interactions are professional, coordinated and aligned with its mission, while protecting the interests of beneficiaries, partners and the organization.

> **Credible organizations build strong reputations through truthful, timely and responsible communication.**